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Weighted kappa: Nominal scale agreement with provision for scaled disagreement or partial credit

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Role in this programme

Origin of the weighted kappa statistic. Chapter 3 adopts quadratic-weighted kappa as a primary agreement metric because severity grades are ordinal, so a one-grade disagreement must not be penalised as heavily as a two-grade one.

ABSTRACT

A previously described coefficient of agreement for nominal scales, kappa, treats all disagreements equally. A generalization to weighted kappa (K_w) is presented. The K_w provides for the incorporation of ratio-scaled degrees of disagreement (or agreement) to each of the cells of the $k \times k$ table of joint nominal scale assignments such that disagreements of varying gravity (or agreements of varying degree) are weighted accordingly. Although providing for partial credit, K_w is fully chance corrected. Its sampling characteristics and procedures for hypothesis testing and setting confidence limits are given. Under certain conditions, K_w equals product-moment r .

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